



BPR

SOPs

for the functioning of

SCHOLARSHIP APPLICATION:

GYAN_SETU

‘Connecting Culture through Knowledge’

KEY STAKEHOLDERS:

A. INDIAN MISSIONS ABROAD

B. UNIVERSITIES/ INSTITUTES

C. ICCR FOREIGN STUDENTS

D. ZONAL/SUB-ZONAL/REGIONAL PASSPORT OFFICES

E. ICCR HEADQUARTERS

<u>ROLES OF STAKEHOLDERS AT DIFFERENT STAGES</u>				
Indian Missions Abroad A.	Universities/ Institutes B.	ICCR Foreign Students C.	ZO/S-ZO/ RPO D.	ICCR HQ E.
STAGE I-<i>Before commencement of Admission Process</i>				
NIL	YES	YES	NIL	YES
STAGE II-<i>During the Admission Process</i>				
YES	YES	YES	NIL	YES
STAGE III-<i>After Admission/ Before Arrival of Students in India</i>				
YES	YES	YES	YES	YES (for information only)
STAGE IV-<i>Post Arrival of Students in India</i>				
YES (for information only)	YES	YES	YES	YES

A. INDIAN MISSIONS ABROAD

II. During the Admission Process:

A2A PORTAL

■ ICCR Schemes/ICAR:

- i. Indian Missions abroad play a significant role in the ICCR Scholarship admissions process, determined by the limited number of scholarship slots allocated to respective countries.
- ii. A common English Proficiency Test by Missions/ICCR or a good TOEFL/IELTS score, obtained within the three months of the application date (to be assessed by the Mission/Post).

- iii. To select the applicants based on the personal information, academic performance, English proficiency test score, and other aspects, keeping in consideration the slot capacity determined by the ICCR HQ
- iv. To allocate one University/Institute to each selected applicant amongst the approved Universities/Institutes, keeping in view the appropriate number leading fair distribution of students in each ZO/S-ZO/RPO and/or University/Institution.

▪ **AYUSH Schemes:**

- v. To scrutinize the student applications based on the predetermined criteria and process it towards ICCR via A2A Portal accordingly, for further verification.
- vi. To receive the College/Institute 'Provisional/Confirmation Letter of Admission' along with the 'ICCR Authorization Letter' and forward it to the concerned students.

III. After Admissions/Before Arrival of Students in India:

GYAN SETU APPLICATION

▪ **For ALL Schemes:**

- vii. **To login to Gyan_Setu web application**, using their respective login credentials provided by ICCR HQ in order to submit the details of selected applicants who have accepted an offer. The application requirements include the list of students who have chosen a course, been assigned to a University and College (if any) with the University Offer Letter, Mission's Scholarship sanctioned letter and ICCR authorization letter and, indicating a date of Joining (tentative).
- viii. To coordinate with these selected applicants to initiate to apply for VISA, filling-up and submission of VISA application with passport. Further, Missions to process Consular Checks and issue the **appropriate VISA**.
- ix. To coordinate with the Universities/Institutes via web application interface and to the Ministry of AYUSH representative at ICCR HQ, for a **common duration of period of arrival of students to the particular University/Institute, to smoothen the reception of students**.
- x. **Travel air tickets** are requested to be issued by the concerned Mission **ONLY** and **not** by the student, **after checking the tentative dates of commencement of course**. Accordingly, the travel itinerary to be finalized and the relevant details including a copy of Air Ticket to be **uploaded in the**

*scholarship web application at least 2 weeks before arrival in India, to facilitate Universities/Institutes to make necessary arrangements. Moreover, the travel would **only be initiated** by the student once the University has accepted those details, however the said details will also be visible to the respective ZO/S-ZO/RPO in the web application.*

- xi. To ensure that the students carry **local currency/US-\$ equivalent to Rs. 50,000/- (Fifty Thousand only)** to meet immediate expenditure on arrival in India, *as the initial payment of stipend will take at least 3-5 weeks after the completion of admission process.*
- xii. **To ensure the travel period of Girl Students are scheduled only during the day. In case, where it is not possible, The Missions should ensure proper coordination of the reception arrangements with the Universities/Institutes and ZO/S-ZO/RPO.**

IV. Post Arrival of Students in India:

- xiii. *Missions will be informed by ICCR HQ* in case of following:
 - *The details submitted by the Student in the Portal, if in case, **wrongly entered or does not match with the submission of documents, the admission of the said student be termed as CANCELLED.***
 - In case, the student is **not promoted** in the current academic year, the ICCR Scholarship of the same may be termed as **SUSPENDED** for the upcoming year. *Accordingly, the student may opt to return to his/her home country or to continue study as self-Finance till all his/her backlogs gets cleared and academic performance gets improved.*
 - In case, the student wishes to **discontinue his/her academic period from the University/Institute, temporarily**, before the completion of his/her course, **the scholarship of the same will immediately be SUSPENDED for a period.**
 - In case, the student wishes to **permanently leave the programme and the University/Institute concerned**, the scholarship of same will be **CANCELLED, immediately after the information.**
 - In case, the student is found in any **Criminal /Anti-Social activities or Political activities or Anti-India activities as well as in Violation of Laws of India/relevant Indian State/UT.** Accordingly, the University/Institute will **RUSTICATE** the student and consequently, the Scholarship of the said student will be **TERMINATED** immediately.
 - After the successful completion of their degree and due formalities **including registration in ICCR Alumni Portal and, before the student leaves the country.**

B. UNIVERSITIES/INSTITUTES

I. Before commencement of Admission Process:

- i. Universities/Institutes to have a **dedicated International Student Centre led by a Senior level faculty (ISA)** and supported by an administrative staff.
- ii. Along with the ISA who is usually a part-time and has professional commitments including taking classes, a **full-time Deputy ISA or a Nodal Officer/Counselor** should be identified and notified by the University/Institute whose details must be entered in the Gyan_Setu application. The Deputy ISA/Nodal Officer/Counselor must be qualified and responsible enough to provide all the relevant information to the students and the ICCR.
- iii. If in case, the students are placed in affiliated colleges of the University, ***ICCR understands this as the sole decision of the Universities/Institutes and that they have a robust internal communication with the college counterparts. However, ICCR to only coordinate and work with University Nodal Officer and not with the officials from the affiliated colleges.*** Nevertheless, only in case of **AYUSH schemes**, ICCR can coordinate with the respective college representative or with the representative of Ministry of AYUSH at ICCR HQ. *However, it is suggested the details of the Nodal Officer, dealing with foreign students in the affiliated colleges should be readily available with the ISA of the respective University/Institute*
- iv. ICCR to only have access to the **one Bank Account** of the Universities/Institutes in order to release the required payments of the ICCR foreign students. The Council understands the responsibility of the Universities/Institutes to disburse payments to its affiliated colleges/departments, as needed.
- v. To **login** to the ICCR Gyan_Setu Web application using login credentials provided by ICCR HQ in order to *upload the following information in the Gyan_Setu web application before the commencement of ICCR admissions for the forthcoming academic year in the A2A Portal:*
 - A **comprehensive list of courses and specializations and eligibility criteria** where the ICCR students can get admitted, together with the names of the Colleges and Hostels that meets the Council admission requirements. The list must be provided in accordance with **the template devised by ICCR**, and the data must be filled under the given validation.
 - To provide **applicable fees for each program/course- Only in INDIAN CURRENCY**, for ICCR students in accordance with the template devised by ICCR *no later than the end of November in the current academic year.* The fees must be known to the Missions/applicants while submitting

their application on the portal. If not provided, **the ICCR will not fund any scholarship to students admitted to the University/Institute concerned.**

- The **availability of International-level hostel facilities** for the ICCR students, *along with necessary information and applicable fees*, to enable students to make an informed choice during the admissions process.
- The fees payable to Universities/Institutes, i.e., Tuition Fees, Other Compulsory Fees and Hostel fees of overall course period *to be provided in advance and that is on Annual basis*. **The fee details once mentioned will not be upgraded or modified or extra charged during the length of the programme.**

Upper cap of fee payable to the concerned Universities/Institutes to be decided by the competent authorities of ICCR and be conveyed accordingly.

II. During the Admission Process:

A2A PORTAL

- vi. To acknowledge each application as **Accepted or Rejected on the portal** based on the students' details following a careful examination of all supporting documentations, including that of Afghan Nationals (including Student VISA and Recommendation Letter by the Embassy of the Islamic Republic of Afghanistan in New Delhi, India, **strictly in accordance with the timelines (and guidelines) conveyed by ICCR**. The course once approved by the Universities/Institutes would **no** longer be modified or changed.
- vii. To provide standard '**Provisional Letter of Admission**' to the selected students on the A2A Portal, including of *Afghan Nationals*, detailing the guidelines, advisory, dos & don'ts, important contact number etc.

III. After Admissions/Before Arrival of Students in India:

GYAN SETU APPLICATION

- viii. To **provide Hostel Accommodation** for all students admitted in respective Universities/Institutes.
- ix. To be well responded with the Indian Missions abroad to provide **a common duration of period of arrival of students to a particular University/Institute** to smoothen the reception of students.

- x. To acknowledge the travel itinerary with the copy of air ticket of the respective student well in 2 weeks advance to provide logical assistance to foreign students including reception at the airport on arrival and temporary accommodation on arrival (if needed).
- xi. **To ensure the travel period of Girl Students are scheduled only during the day. In case, where it is not possible, The Missions should ensure proper coordination of the reception arrangements with the Universities/Institutes and ZO/S-ZO/RPO.**
- xii. To provide an **authentic contact detail of an official** authorized for the reception of students, to enable students to contact the same once arrived in India.

IV. Post Arrival of Students in India:

GYAN SETU APPLICATION

- xiii. To **confirm the arrival of students** to their respective **ZO/S-ZO/RPO** by providing the **date of arrival in India.** The confirmation and details of the students to be uploaded in the web/mobile application.
- xiv. **Verification of Documents/Confirmation of Admission**-To check and verify the details of students mentioned in in the A2A Portal during the admission process with their original **documents** including Passport, previous degree certificates, country's unique identification number, in order to **confirm the admission** of students and provide the University/Institute **Authentication Letter (Bonafide)** with **Hostel Accommodation** as soon as the admission of the student is confirmed. **PLEASE NOTE**-The details entered in the Portal, if in case, does not match with the original documents, the admission of the said student be termed as **CANCELLED**.
- xv. To organize a **detailed Orientation Session** soon after the arrival of the students explaining all the necessary rules and regulations for the international students including dos and don'ts, a brief on local conditions and accessibility to bank and others. The **orientation details with confirmed list** of students to be provided in the Gyan Setu Application.
- xvi. To **facilitate ICCR Students for registration with FRRO, opening a bank account, medical insurance, availing Indian sim-card number, extra classes for foreign students (language and other subjects) and other necessities required.**
- xvii. To ensure that all the **student requisites are filled by the student in the Gyan Setu Mobile Application.**
- xviii. To ensure the **medium of teaching in English language only** and not in Hindi or local language.

- xix. ***Other necessary Documents-*** Universities/Institutes to **ensure** that all the required details including, *FRRO number, Bank Account details, Medical Insurance Policy number, Indian Sim-card number Roll number, Enrollment number, Hostel Details* are ***filled*** by their students in the mobile application within **20 days of arrival in India** and accordingly **Verify** all these details including student/course-wise payment details, being provided before admissions, to become eligible/liable for the payment requests.
- xx. **To confirm the receipt of payments being made by the respective ZO/S-ZO/RPO.** If this confirmation is not completed within 5 days of the payment intimation, the system will automatically record that the payment has been received by the University/Institute concerned.
- xxi. To **verify** the details of monthly recorded attendance and the details of Ex-India Leave submitted by each student and validate the same by the end of every month in the Gyan_Setu web Application. **Delay/Failed** to validate the details will restrain from releasing stipend and other payments to the student.
- xxii. **To strictly monitor the attendance of the admitted students** and if, find the case of **discontinuation of student** from academic period, temporarily, before the completion of his/her course, or to **permanently leave the programme and the University/Institute concerned**, the same should **immediately be informed via Gyan_Setu mobile/web application** and accordingly, the scholarship of the particular student will be **SUSPENDED** for a period or **permanently CANCELLED** respectively. **Hence, the Attendance monitoring plays an important role in this aspect.**
- xxiii. To **verify the Academic Progress details** submitted by each student and validate the same by confirming the status of promotion to next academic year with the copy of grade card attached with the updated details of the students, at the end of each academic year in the web Application, to facilitate the respective ZO/S-ZO/RPO to release fee payment to the Universities/Institutes and payment to the students as well.
- xxiv. **Please note that**, if in case, the students are **not promoted** in the current academic year, the ICCR Scholarship of the same may be termed as **SUSPENDED** for the upcoming year. Accordingly, ***the student may opt to return to his/her home country or to continue study as self-Finance till all his/her backlogs gets cleared and academic performance gets improved.***
- xxv. To generate the **Exit Report** of each student at the end of course period consist of all relevant information of the student completion of degree, settlement of account and others.
- xxvi. University/Institute shall have a right to **RUSTICATE** the student if found in any ***Criminal /Anti-Social activities or Political activities or Anti-India activities as well as in Violation of Laws of India/relevant Indian State/UT,*** and accordingly, inform the same via web application to concerned ZO/S-

ZO/RPO in order to **TERMINATE** the *Scholarship of the said student on immediate basis*.

The Universities/Institutes should fulfill all the given responsibilities mentioned above in the specified time frame. The compliance of the Universities/Institutes with respect to all these responsibilities will enable ICCR to fund them and the students enrolled in the particular University/Institute in near future.

C. ICCR FOREIGN STUDENTS

I. Before commencement of Admission Process:

- i. Students/Applicants to secure a **good score in a common English Proficiency Test** conducted by Missions/ICCR or TOEFL/IELTS exam, not later than 3 months before the date of application proceedings on A2A Portal.

II. During the Admission Process:

A2A PORTAL

- ii. Students to enter all the information mentioned in the A2A Portal in the **prescribed format only. The details entered should be sincerely and correctly filled as there would be no provision of changes or modifications in the later stage.**
- iii. **Cancellation (I): PLEASE NOTE-**The details submitted in the Portal, if in case, wrongly entered or does not match at the time of submission of documents, the admission of the said student be termed as **CANCELLED**.
- iv. To note down **the Application Unique ID** once the application form is submitted, for later reference.
- v. Students to understand that the decision of **selection of the candidates is entirely at the discretion of the Indian Missions/Embassies**, based on the parameters, including personal details, academic performance, English proficiency test Score, and others, keeping in consideration with the given slots.
- vi. Updates on the admission can be viewed on A2A Portal or on their respective emails and consequently, Students selected by the respective Missions to give consent on the Portal by **Accepting/Rejecting** the admission offer within the stipulated time of the Missions.

▪ **Afghan Nationals**

- vii. ***Eligible Afghan Nationals*** residing in India could be considered for ICCR Scholarships and can apply for the admission for the academic year 2023-24 through the external link available on A2A Portal based on the following parameters:
- **Valid Passport and Student VISA**
 - **Residential permit (FRRO)**
 - **Recommendation Letter** from the Embassy of the Islamic Republic of Afghanistan in New Delhi, India
 - **Proficiency in English**
 - **Provisional Letter of Admission** from the University/ Institute (*after applied on the Portal*).

Scholarship to Afghan nationals will only be awarded on the recommendation of PAI Division of MEA, GOI.

- viii. **PLEASE NOTE-**The details submitted in the Portal, if in case, wrongly entered or does not match with the submission of documents, the admission of the said student be termed as **CANCELLED**.
- ix. ***Eligible Afghan Nationals*** to note down the **Application Unique ID** once the application form is submitted, for later reference.
- x. Updates on the admission can be viewed on A2A Portal or on their respective emails and consequently selected Students to give consent on the Portal by **Accepting/Rejecting** the admission offer within the stipulated time.

III. After Admissions/Before Arrival of Students in India:

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- xi. Students, who accept the ICCR Scholarship, may approach to the concerned Indian Mission/Post for **issuance of ‘Award of Scholarship Letter’** with directions to initiate to apply for Student/Research VISA. And later, to get updates of consular check and issuance of VISA.
- xii. They are directed to **NOT to book the travel tickets on their own** as the date of arrival in India will be finalized and the air tickets accordingly need to be booked with the due consent of Universities and Missions both, keeping in consideration the tentative dates of commencement of classes.
- xiii. They are directed to carry **local currency/US \$ equivalent to Rs. 50,000/- (Fifty Thousand only)** to meet their immediate expenditure on arrival in India, as the initial payment of stipend will take at least 3-5 weeks after the completion of admission process.

- xiv. For **arrival/reception in India**, Universities/Institutes will facilitate the necessary logistic assistance to the students for a given period reception. Accordingly, **the contact details of the authorized person will be provided** by each University/Institute **one week prior to the journey of each student to enable them to contact the official once arrived.**
- xv. **GIRL STUDENTS are directed to come during the day-time ONLY. To ensure the travel period of Girl Students are scheduled only during the day. In case, where it is not possible, The Missions should ensure proper coordination of the reception arrangements with the Universities/Institutes and ZO/S-ZO/RPO.**

IV. Post Arrival of Students in India:

GYAN SETU APPLICATION

- xvi. Students are directed to report their arrival on the Gyan_Setu web application on an immediate basis.
- xvii. Directed to report ***first to the concerned University/Institute*** and NOT to the respective ZO/S-ZO/RPO, to complete formalities.
- xviii. ***Submission & Verification of Documents/Confirmation of Admission***-To submit the original documents and verify the details mentioned in the A2A Portal during the admission process with their original **documents** including Passport, previous degree certificates, country's unique identification number, in order to **confirm the admission** of students and get the ***Hostel Accommodation*** **as soon as the admission is confirmed.** **PLEASE NOTE-** The details entered in the Portal, if in case, **does not match** with the original documents, the admission of the said student be termed as **CANCELLED**.
- xix. Students must procure an **Indian Android-based mobile phone and a SIM card**. The mobile phones must have enough hardware and software capability so that the ICCR app can be hosted and run from the device.
- xx. To download **ICCR Scholarship Application from the Google play store** and do login by filling the ***'Application number as Username and Passport number as Password'***. **Students are directed to not to share their login credentials with anyone.**
- xxi. Post Orientation programme, **Students are required to enter all the information required in the mobile application** including the details of, VISA, Bank Account, FRRO, Medical Insurance, Indian contact number, WhatsApp number, Course details, Roll number and other requisites with a copy of the document (wherever required), to enable Universities/Institute to verify the same and ZO/S-ZO/RPO to release the student stipend.

- xxii. To enter **hostel/outside residence details** with the complete address and a copy of agreement. *The same should be validated from concerned University/Institute.*
- xxiii. **INITIAL STIPEND:** Please note that the **Initial Stipend** will **ONLY** be received after sincerely following of all the above steps mentioned in **paras (xvi-xxii)**.
- xxiv. Students are required to submit **monthly attendance record and the details of Ex-India Leave by uploading a copy of passport consists of emigration and immigration stamp**. The required details need to be filled not later by **25th of every month**. **Failed/Delay to submit the attendance will make the scholarship stipend on HOLD.**
- xxv. Students to mark the **Academic Progress details** in the mobile application with a copy of grade card immediately after the results are announced, at the end of each academic year. **Failed/Delay to submit the academic progress will make the scholarship stipend on HOLD.**
- xxvi. **Suspension (I): Please note,** if in case, the student is **not promoted** in the current academic year, the ICCR Scholarship of the same may be termed as **SUSPENDED** for the upcoming year. *Accordingly, the student may opt to return to his/her home country or to continue study as self-Finance till all his/her backlogs gets cleared and academic performance gets improved.*
- xxvii. For any **changes/updates** in any of the existing Student records, they need to send an update request in the application by entering the updated information and upload a copy of the document for further verification. **The document will not be changed till the time the respective ZO/S-ZO/RPO verifies it.**
- xxviii. **Subsequent Payments/Stipends:** To note, **timely uploading/submission** all the information by the students given in above paras will **enable ICCR ZO/S-ZO/RPO to release necessary payments on time**. The status of the payments can be checked by students on their mobile app.
- xxix. **Suspension (II):** In case, the student wishes to **discontinue his/her academic period from the University/Institute, temporarily**, before the completion of his/her course, it should be **informed via Gyan_Setu mobile application to the respective University/Institute and the concerned ZO/S-ZO/RPO and accordingly, the scholarship of the same will immediately be SUSPENDED for a period.**
- xxx. **Cancellation (II):** In case, the student wishes to **permanently leave the programme and the University/Institute concerned**, it should be **informed via Gyan_Setu mobile application**. Accordingly, the scholarship of same will be **CANCELLED, immediately after the information.**
- xxxi. **Termination:** Students are **directed NOT** to indulge in ***Criminal /Anti-Social activities or Political activities or Anti-India activities as well as in Violation of Laws of India/relevant Indian State/UT***. If found in any such

activities, University/Institute shall have a right to **RUSTICATE** the student and consequently, the Scholarship of the said student will be **TERMINATED** immediately.

- xxxii. **Alumni Portal:** After the successful completion of their degree, students to complete due formalities of Exit Report and other necessary requirements. In addition, it is mandatory for students to enter all their details on the **ICCR Alumni Portal** before leaving the country.

D. ZONAL/SUB-ZONAL/REGIONAL PASSPORT OFFICE

III. After Admissions/Before Arrival of Students in India:

GYAN SETU APPLICATION

- i. ZO/S-ZO/RPO (Head) to login in the Gyan_Setu mobile/web application by using login credentials provided by ICCR HQ.
- ii. The ZO/S-ZO/RPO to collect the students' details who have selected for admissions in the respective Zone/Sub-Zone/Region. The data can be availed, and report can be generated in the application database.
- iii. ZO/S-ZO/RPO will be on loop in all communications (with details) of **Missions and Universities/Institutes** regarding **Travel and Reception arrangements** of the students, through the web application
- iv. **Kindly note that the reception of the students with all the logistic support to be facilitated by Universities/Institutes ONLY and NOT BY THE ZO/S-ZO/RPO.**

IV. Post Arrival of Students in India:

GYAN SETU APPLICATION

- v. To ensure the confirmation of arrival of students with the date of arrival in India, being submitted by the Universities/Institutes in the ICCR scholarship web/mobile application.
- vi. To be informed by the Universities/Institutes about the **Verified** list of students with the initial requisites including date of joining of course and the details of their orientation programme.
- vii. ZO/S-ZO/RPO to issue **ICCR Authentication Letter (*Bonafide*) only to the list of Verified Students**, shared by respective Universities/Institutes.

- viii. To **ONLY** coordinate with the **Nodal Officers** of the respective Universities/Institutes under their jurisdiction, whose details are mentioned in the Gyan_Setu application. If in case, the students are placed in affiliated colleges of the University, ***ICCR understands this as the sole decision of the Universities/Institutes and that they have a robust internal communication with the college counterparts. However, ICCR to only coordinate and work with Universities/Institutes' Nodal Officer and not with the officials from any affiliated Colleges.*** Nevertheless, only in case of AYUSH schemes, ICCR can coordinate with the respective college representative or with the representative of Ministry of AYUSH at ICCR HQ. ***However, it is suggested the details of the Nodal Officer, dealing with foreign students in the affiliated colleges should be readily available with the ISA of the respective University/Institute***
- ix. To **confirm the certified details of Students with the required documents, submitted by respective Universities/Institutes as a part of Joining Report, in the said application. Please ensure that the payment requested by the Universities/Institutes are only in INDIAN CURRENCY and on annual basis for the full duration of the course.**
- x. The **Joining reports** can be generated from the web application by the ZO/S-ZO/RPO, for further reference. **All these Joining Reports are required to be retrieved and submitted to ICCR HQ via web application so that the file number for all students can be issued.**
- xi. ZO/S-ZO/RPO becomes liable to pay the necessary fee and stipend to the University/Institute and student respectively soon after the Joining Reports are verified by the Universities/Institutes and confirmed by the respective ZO/S-ZO/RPO. Accordingly, ***the payment pending status will be shown soon after (one week later) the details of the students submitted by the University are confirmed.***
- xii. To kindly note that no payment to the student could be initiated without getting File No. from the ICCR HQ.
- xiii. To only access **one Bank Account of the Universities/Institutes** for releasing the required payments of the ICCR foreign students. **The Council understands the responsibility of the University to disburse the payments to various colleges/departments, if required.**
- xiv. **Payment Process-** Payments to the Universities/Institutes be initiated by downloading the **Demand letter template** from the web application, only of those students whose details have been verified by the respective Universities/Institutes and confirmed by the respective ZO/S-ZO/RPO. The Demand Letter can be used as **Reference Document for preparing Bill.** Accordingly, the Final Bill can be prepared by entering the details in the Bill Template and the same can be used for further validations and processing

payment through PFMS. Account section to enter the accounts related details after the payment is made.

- xv. **Payment to Universities/Institutes including Tuition Fee and Other Compulsory Fee** be made strictly on **YEARLY basis** and not semester-wise. However, the **Hostel Fee** be made **semester-wise only**. Payment of the initial year to be made only after the Verification of the student records. Accordingly, the payment for the subsequent years be made only after the receipt of results (with updated records of students), certified by Universities/Institutes. Hence, depending upon the **submitting of Joining Reports for the first-year students and uploading the results for the subsequent years the relevant Demand Letter will be automatically generated and be referred for the process of payments.**
- xvi. **After Payment-** To get the **receipt of payment confirmation** from the Universities/Institutes. If the confirmation is **not processed** by the Universities/Institutes within 5 days of the payment intimation, the system will automatically record that the payment has been received by the University/Institute concerned.
- xvii. To respond on the ***requests made by the students for changes (if any) occurred in their personal information and do the necessary validations.***
- xviii. Following **Report Templates** can be availed and generated in the web application with the numerous filters (wherever required):
- Joining Report
 - Bona-fide
 - Status of LIVE Students
 - LIVE Students Report
 - Expenditure Report (Student-wise)
 - Scheme-wise Student Report
 - Reference Sheet (for payment purpose)
 - Bill (for payment purpose)
 - Ledger
 - Advance Fee Structure (for Universities/Institutes)
 - Demand Letter/Utilization Certificate
 - Month-wise/Scheme-wise Agency/Non-Agency Expenditure Details
- xix. For the LIVE Students, **Input Data Template (with data validation)** will be provided in the application to enter the details of students. ZO/S-ZO/RPO are **directed to fill the data strictly on the basis of prescribed format as per the approved nomenclature.**
- xx. For the LIVE and upcoming batch of foreign students, the Input Data template for the payment purpose will be availed in the web application subject to data validation. The **expenditure details to be strictly entered in a prescribed**

format/ set nomenclature, failed to which/otherwise, the details entered would not be accepted in the system.

- xxi. Payment to the Students including Stipend and HRA to be strictly made on QUARTERLY basis and not on monthly basis. However, the book allowance, i.e. ACA to be made on annual-basis. The Payment of the student including stipend, HRA should only be initiated as per the certified records of **Student monthly attendance with the details of EX-India Leaves and yearly progress, being submitted by the Universities/Institutes.** ZO/S-ZO/RPO are **not allowed to initiate any kind of payment to the students without availing of the said records.**
- xxii. The **payment voucher** for the students' payments to be treated as same as the **Reference Sheet Template, available in the web application.** Subsequently, the **final bill** will be made by entering the payment details in the **Bill Template, available in the web application.**
- xxiii. After the confirmation of payment, being made in the PFMS system. The payment details including bill number, voucher number, payment advice number with date, to be entered in the web application by selecting the individual application number (also called as Unique ID) of the student.
- xxiv. In case of **Payment failed or bounced back**, the **status of the same entry in the web application be chosen as 'Receipt' and be termed as the negative entry for the system.** Accordingly, a fresh process for the new payment entry to be initiated.
- xxv. In case, the student **is not promoted** in the subsequent/next academic year in the University/Institute, temporarily, before the completion of his/her course, the ZO/S-ZO/RPO is **directed to request ICCR HQ via web application interface, for the SUSPENSION of scholarship for a period of time, immediately after notified by the University/Institute. The remaining period of scholarship should be readjusted accounting for this period of temporary suspension.** (In this case, the student may opt to return to his/her home country or to continue study as self-Finance till all his/her backlogs gets cleared and academic performance gets improved.)
- xxvi. In case, the student **is discontinued** his/her academic period from the University/Institute, temporarily, before the completion of his/her course, the ZO/S-ZO/RPO is **directed to request ICCR HQ via web application interface, for the SUSPENSION of scholarship for a period of time, immediately after notified by the University/Institute.**
- xxvii. In case, the student **permanently leaves the programme and the University/Institute concerned**, the ZO/S-ZO/RPO is then, **directed to request ICCR HQ via web application interface for the permanent CANCELLATION of scholarship of the particular student, immediately after notified by the University/Institute.**

- xxviii. ZO/S-ZO/RPO to submit the request to ICCR HQ for the **TERMINATION of the student Scholarship immediately after University/Institute notifies the RUSTICATION case via web application, providing accurate information about the student involvement in any Criminal /Anti-Social activities or Political activities or Anti-India activities as well as any Violation of Laws of India/relevant Indian State/UT.**
- xxix. ZO/S-ZO/RPO may kindly note that the admission process of **Afghan Students** has mentioned under sub head 'ICCR Foreign Students' part 'Afghan Nationals' para '(vii)-(x)'; and under sub head 'ICCR HQ' part 'Afghan Nationals' para '(vii)-(ix)'.

E. ICCR Headquarters (HQ)

- ICCR Gyan_Setu Application to have a link access of the A2A Portal database to access the details of the students selected for the ICCR Scholarship.

I. Before commencement of Admission Process:

GYAN SETU APPLICATION

- i. ICCR HQ to convey the ***scholarship slot capacities*** to each Indian Missions Abroad fixed for the respective countries.
- ii. ICCR HQ to have a ***role to cap the maximum fees limit to be payable to the Universities/Institutes, that can be equal to the fees charged by the Indian students.***
- iii. In case, the students are placed in affiliated colleges of the University, **ICCR understands this as University/Institute sole decision, and both must have a robust internal communication for the ICCR students. Hence, ICCR HQ/ZO/S-ZO/RPO to only coordinate with University/Institute Nodal Officer and not with the officials of the affiliated colleges.**
- iv. ICCR HQ to consider ***Universities/Institutes' course-wise (college-wise) authorization of full course Fee Payment from the proposed 'Advance Fee structure'*** uploaded by the selected Universities/Institutes as per the given template in the Gyan_Setu web application (before the commencement of admission process), detailing all the components of programmes and payments, including hostel fees, for the whole academic period. **The fee approvals to be taken well in advance and before the commencement of admissions in A2A Portal.**

II. During the Admission Process:

A2A PORTAL

- v. **At the time of the submission of the application by the students, the fee structure for the whole duration of said courses of Universities/Institutes should have been approved by the Competent Authorities.**
- vi. **NO upward changes/revision in the fee structure, once submitted by the universities for whole course period, will be approved/allowed by the ICCR HQ.**
- **Afghan Nationals**
 - vii. To select the ***Eligible Afghan Nationals*** (*valid Passport and Student VISA; Residential permit (FRRO); Recommendation Letter from the Embassy of the Islamic Republic of Afghanistan in New Delhi, India; Provisional Letter of Admission from the University/ Institute*) based on their personal information, academic performance, English proficiency test score, and other aspects, keeping in consideration the slot capacity determined for the particular Scheme.
 - viii. To consider final selection of ***Eligible Afghan Nationals*** only after the necessary recommendations from the **PAI Division of MEA, GOI.**
 - ix. To allocate one University/Institute to each selected applicant amongst the approved Universities/Institutes, keeping in view the appropriate number leading fair distribution of students in each ZO/S-ZO/RPO and/or University/Institution.

III. After Admissions/Before Arrival of Students in India:

- x. ICCR HQ to oversee the admission and arrival process in the web application.

IV. Post Arrival of Students in India:

- xi. ICCR HQ to complete the formalities of allocating students' File Number within one week of receiving Joining Report from ZO/S-ZO/RPO through the application, to enable them to initiate their payment process.
- xii. HQ with the approval of the Competent Authorities, to complete the formalities of **Suspension or Cancellation or Termination** of the student Scholarship, once the request is received (if any) from the ZO/S-ZO/RPO (mentioned under sub head 'ZO/S-ZO/RPO' para '(xxiv)-(xxvii)')

- xiii. HQ can generate at least **15 Reports** and can also have further filter from the said Reports depending upon its requirements.
- xiv. To monitor all the payment/expenditure made to universities/institutes and students including any duplicate payments, payments failed or bounced back.
- xv. To set strict timelines for each stakeholder to complete the part under the given timeframe since the information being uploaded are interdependent by the listed stakeholders. This will avoid any delay in the whole process of admissions and payments and will ensure giving the correct status of Scholarship implementation at any point of time.

Any queries during or after the admission process which other stakeholders are unable to address will be sought it out by ICCR HQ

MOTTO

Competent Authorities of ICCR HQ to analyze the data and monitor the performance of the Students; Universities/Institutes; ZO/S-ZO/RPO and ICCR HQ under various parameters for making any counter checks and balances in the process of any of the stakeholders given their defined timelines for ensuring and tapping, optimizing and utilizing the full potential of Gyan Setu (mobile/web) application.
